



Tips & Tricks



Message of the day

Normally when you log into a console you aren't greeted by any message (except in openSUSE, which always tells you to "Have a lot of fun!"). If you want to be greeted by a message the moment you log in, you can add that message in the `/etc/motd` file.

—Vaseem Javeed, vaseemjaveed@gmail.com



The CPU isn't busy; it's time to run

If you want to run a program or command when the CPU is free or not very busy, the tool you need is `batch`. It only executes commands when the system load levels permit. In other words, when the load average drops below 1.5, or the value specified in the invocation of `atd`.

```
echo 'tar czf /tmp/mydocstargz /home/me/docs/' | batch
```

...or enter:

```
batch
```

...and the following prompt appears at your console:

```
at>
```

You can type the command and press `Ctrl + d` to save the job.

—Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com



Mounting NTFS partition on RHEL

You should first install a package called `ntfs-3g`. Open the terminal and type:

```
yum install ntfs-3g
```

To auto mount the NTFS partition, add a line to

```
/etc/fstab:
```

```
/dev/sda2 /mnt/ ntfs defaults 0 0
```

...followed by:

```
mount -a
```

Your NTFS partition should now become accessible.

—Vijith PA, vijith.pa@gmail.com



Selecting alternative apps in Debian

In order to change the default Web browser of Debian GNU/Linux, you can use the `update-alternatives` command as follows:

```
$ sudo update-alternatives --config x-www-browser
```

There are 4 alternatives which provide 'x-www-browser'.

Selection	Alternative
1	/usr/bin/epiphany
2	/usr/bin/iceweasel
*+ 3	/usr/bin/konqueror
4	/usr/bin/epiphany-gecko

Press enter to keep the default[*], or type selection number:

Note that the asterisk sign indicates Konqueror is currently the default browser. In order to switch the